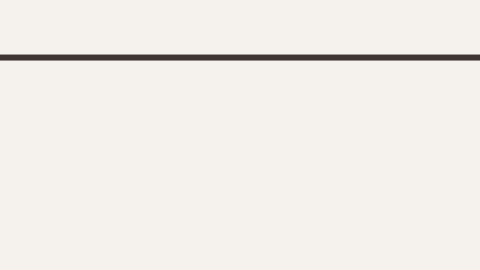




Indigenous political participation in Canada : moving beyond voting to understand a variety of political means and actions

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Acknowledgements

- Thanks to the researchers and collaborators at *Consortium on Electoral Democracy*
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(Harell et coll., 2022a, 2022b, 2023, 2024, 2025).



Outline

1. Puzzle
2. Literature review (very quick overview)
3. Research question
4. Theoretical framework
5. Hypothesis (a lot → 9)
6. Data and Methodology
- 7. Results**
- 8. Discussion**
9. Conclusion

Puzzle

- **Electoral participation inequalities** exist in Canada;
- Indigenous Peoples **vote less** than other Canadians;
(Beatty et al., 2013; Harell and Panagos, 2013; Howe and Bedford, 2009; Dabin et al., 2019).
- Their needs and preferences are **not reflected in public policy**;
(Dahl, 1980; Dahl, 1985).
- **Nonetheless**, other ways are present to express their needs and preferences.

Puzzle

- The **bulk** of indigenous political participation literature in Canada has been focused on its **electoral** component.
 - Accessibility of polling station data for *territorial communities* only.
- We know little about other political acts in a **quantitative way** and at an **individual level**.
 - Scarcity of indigenous respondents in general population surveys.
- **Furthermore**, rare are the studies that compare indigenous political participation across types of participation from one dataset : **it's scattered**.
- What we need : **current state** of indigenous political participation in Canada.

→ what I've set up myself to do

Literature review

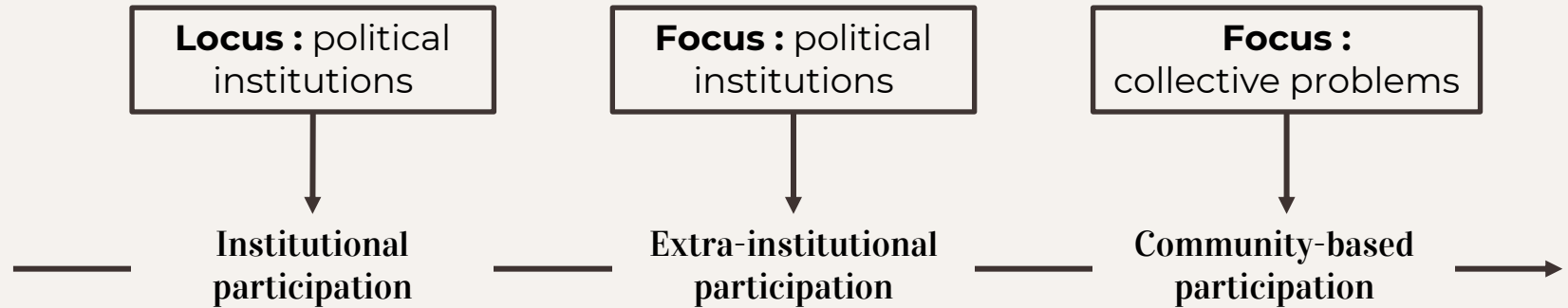
- Indigenous people in Canada **vote at lower rates** than non-indigenous Canadians.
(Beatty et coll., 2013; Harell et Panagos, 2013; Howe et Bedford, 2009; Dabin et al., 2019).
- The **frequency** of Indigenous **direct acts** is constantly **rising** since the 1960's.
(Do, 2023; Ramos, 2006; Wilkes, 2004).
- Indigenous people tend to **participate more within identity and cultural related organisation** than they do in other types of organisation.
(Estes et al., 2023; Harell, 2013;).
- Many researchers have hinted the **utmost importance** of **resources** (*see the lack thereof*) to explain indigenous **electoral** participation.
- **However**, as we move out from institutional acts of participation, **resources** tend to discriminate to a lesser extent the participants from the non-participants.

What are the explanations for the diverse forms of Indigenous political participation in Canada?

Research question

Theoretical framework

- Individual factors of the **civic voluntarism model (CVM)**.
(Verba et al., 1995).
- A conceptual definition of political participation (conceptual distance of political acts from formal institutions).
(Van Deth, 2014).



Hypothesis

- Descriptive hypothesis to test the association between **institutional distance** and the **type of participation**.

H1 : the **further** the political act is happening from the political institution, more the level of participation is **high**.

Hypothesis

- Two hypothesis to test the contribution of a **resource-based** explanation and a **psychological engagement-based** explanation of political participation.

H2a : resources have a **larger** effect on **institutional** participation than on non-institutional participation.

H2b : psychological engagement has a **larger** effect on **non-institutional** participation than on institutional participation.

Hypothesis (halfway there !)

- Three hypothesis to test the association between **issue engagement** (Verba et coll., 1995) and political participation.

H3a : Agreement that "a long history of colonial policies harms the social and economic well-being of Indigenous Peoples" is associated with **lower levels** of **institutional** participation among Indigenous people.

H3b : Agreement that "a long history of colonial policies harms the social and economic well-being of Indigenous Peoples" is associated with **higher levels** of **non-institutional** participation among Indigenous people.

H4 : Agreement that "Indigenous Peoples have received less than they deserve" is associated with **higher levels** of both **institutional** and **non-institutional** participation among Indigenous people.

Hypothesis (last ones !)

- Three hypothesis to test specific factors of a **mobilisation-based** explanation.
(McClurg, 2003; Putnam, 2000; Verba et coll., 1995).

H5a : Greater ethnocultural diversity within one's social network is associated with **higher levels** of **institutional** participation (***bridging***).

H5b : Lower ethnocultural diversity within one's social network is associated with **higher levels** of **extra-institutional** participation (***bonding***).

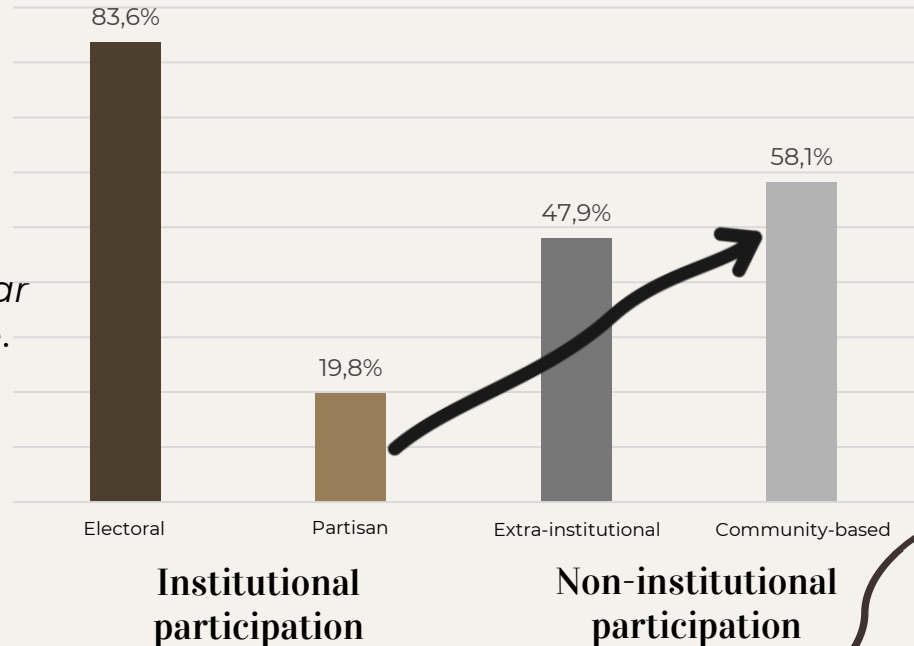
H6 : Both a **larger social network** and **higher frequency of political discussions** are associated with **higher levels** of both **institutional** and **non-institutional** participation.

Data and methodology

- *Democracy Checkups survey (2020 to 2024).*
- **Descriptive analysis** : measuring self-reported political participation of indigenous respondents (n = 1120).
 - 4 dependent variables : electoral, partisan, extra-institutional and community-based participation.
- **Block-recursive ordered logistic regression analysis** : to identify direction and strength of association between **CVM** independent variables and political participation (n = 1120, n = 810).
 - 2 dependent variables : **institutional** and **non-institutional** participation (each a 0-4 scale of reported political participation).
 - Metric : OR (SE)^{statistical significance}.

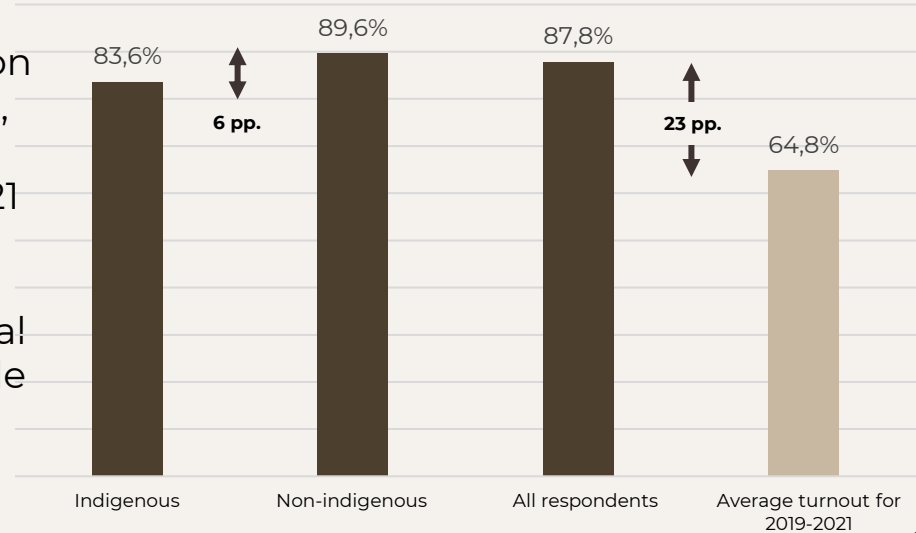
R1 – distance and participation

- Expected relation is **partially respected**.
- **Voting** remains the political act *par excellence* for Indigenous people.



R1 – in addition

- Self-reported electoral participation is **very high** for **ALL** respondents, and much higher than actual electoral participation in 2019-2021 federal elections.
- High self-reported level of electoral participation by Indigenous people **could reproduce** differences observed for all respondents.



R2a – explaining participations

Variable	Model 1A (Inst.)	Model 6A (Non-inst.)
<i>Resources</i>		
Age	1.02 (0.00)***	1.00 (0.00)
Education	1.51 (0.09)***	1.35 (0.08)***
Income	1.18 (0.06)**	1.09 (0.05)
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.039	0.016
Δ McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.025	0.007
N	1,120	1,119

- A **resource-based** explanation of institutional participation **holds**;
- **Resources** have an effect **more than 3 times** larger on institutional participation;
- **BUT** it couldn't be applied to non-institutional participation.

R2b – explaining participations

Variable	Model 2A (Inst.)	Model 7A (Non-inst.)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>		
Political interest	1.77 (0.09) ^{***}	1.73 (0.08) ^{***}
Internal political efficacy	1.11 (0.07)	1.06 (0.06)
External political efficacy	1.02 (0.07)	0.92 (0.06)
Strength of partisan identification	1.58 (0.06) ^{***}	1.23 (0.05) ^{***}
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.090	0.042
Δ McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.051	0.026
N	1,120	1,119

- **Psychological engagement** variables have a slightly larger effect on **institutional** participation.
- Its contribution to institutional participation is **as much as twice** that to non-institutional participation.
- **However**, this explanation holds **central** to each type of political participation.

R3/4 – indigenous issue engagement

Variable	Model 3 (Inst.)	Model 8 (Non-inst.)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>		
Political interest	1.72 (0.10)***	1.65 (0.09)***
Internal political efficacy	1.15 (0.08) [†]	1.07 (0.08)
External political efficacy	1.02 (0.08)	0.92 (0.07)
Strength of partisan identification	1.53 (0.07)***	1.18 (0.06)**
<i>Issue engagement</i>		
Colonial political issues — historical	0.89 (0.12)	0.97 (0.11)
Colonial political issues — redistribution	0.95 (0.11)	1.01 (0.10)
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.086	0.041
Δ McFadden pseudo- R^2	-0.004	-0.001
N	811	810

- Negative, small and non-significant associations.
- **1st limit** : survey questions ask for **agreement** rather than the **saliency** of an issue on the decision to participate.
- **2nd limit** : The module *Attitudes – Colonialism and Indigenous* deserve addresses **resentment** which may not fit conceptually here*.

*Thanks to Allison Harell (Professor, UQÀM) for the precision.

R3/4 – indigenous issue engagement

Variable	Model 3 (Inst.)	Model 8 (Non-inst.)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>		
Political interest	1.72 (0.10)***	1.65 (0.09)***
Internal political efficacy	1.15 (0.08) [†]	1.07 (0.08)
External political efficacy	1.02 (0.08)	0.92 (0.07)
Strength of partisan identification	1.53 (0.07)***	1.18 (0.06)**
<i>Issue engagement</i>		
Colonial political issues — historical	0.89 (0.12)	0.97 (0.11)
Colonial political issues — redistribution	0.95 (0.11)	1.01 (0.10)
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.086	0.041
Δ McFadden pseudo- R^2	-0.004	-0.001
N	811	810

- **3rd limit** : The effect might remain **undetectable** because my dependent variables remains **general** in scope (Verba et al., 1995: 393);
- **4th limit** : The size of the Indigenous subsample might hinder the detection of a weak association.

R5/6 – mobilization and social networks

Variable	Model 4 (Inst.)	Model 9 (Non-inst.)
<i>Mobilization</i>		
Frequency of political discussions	1.35 (0.10)**	1.38 (0.09)***
Social network size	0.94 (0.10)	0.91 (0.09)
Social network diversity	1.15 (0.09)	1.51 (0.09)***
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.092	0.058
Δ McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.006	0.017
N	811	810

- Moderate to strong positive association between **ethnocultural diversity** and **institutional** and **non-institutional** participation.
- **Limit** : Community group type isn't specified. **Could** influence the relation between **diversity of social networks** and **non-institutional participation**.

R5/6 – mobilization and social networks

Variable	Model 4 (Inst.)	Model 9 (Non-inst.)
<i>Mobilization</i>		
Frequency of political discussions	1.35 (0.10)**	1.38 (0.09)***
Social network size	0.94 (0.10)	0.91 (0.09)
Social network diversity	1.15 (0.09)	1.51 (0.09)***
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.092	0.058
Δ McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.006	0.017
N	811	810

- The intensity of **social interactions** (as measured by social network size) is negative, weak and non-significant.
- The **political value** of social networks – *the frequency of political discussions* – is strongly associated with both types of political participation.

Summary of hypothesis

	Expected association	Results	Support	
H1	further = higher participation	Vote = most, but rest suits expectation	PARTIALLY REJECTED	✗
H2a	Resources effect bigger on institutional	Age and education ++, income =	SUPPORTED	✓
H2b	Psychological engagement effect bigger on non-institutional	Political interest and strenght of partisan indentity ++ for institutional.	REJECTED	✗
H3a	Agreement = lower institutional participation	Negative, small and non-significative	LIMITED SUPPORT	✓
H3b	Agreement = higher non-institutional participation	Negative, small and non-significative	REJECTED	✗
H4	Agreement = higher participation	Negative, small and non-significative	REJECTED	✗
H5a	More diversity = institutional participation higher	Positive, moderate and significant	SUPPORTED (with caution)	✓
H5b	Less diversity = non-institutional participation higher	Positive, strong and significant	REJECTED	✗
H6	Bigger social network More frequent political discussions = participation higher	Frequency = strong, positive and significant, Size of social networks = negative, small and not significant	REJECTED	✗

Discussion – theoretical framework

- **Possible mismatch** between institutional **distance** and **resource demands** across participation types.
- Each dependent variable **includes different modes** of participation that are constraining in terms of time, money, or relatively less constraining.
- This could **attenuate differences in participation levels** and/or associations with explanatory factors.

Discussion – data

- **Broadening** the definition of political participation to account for Indigenous realities by including community-based participation type.

(Alfred, 2007; Corntassel, 2012; Coulthard, 2014; Estes et coll., 2023).

- **However**, do these types of community-based participation align with Indigenous understandings of participation ?
 - Formal organisations, structured participation vs. informal community-based participation, traditional acts (Estes et coll., 2023) ;
 - Little room for **decolonial/Indigenous conceptualizations** of participation (Greaves, 2023).

Conclusion

Reminder : What are the explanations for the diverse forms of Indigenous political participation in Canada ?

- **Psychological engagement** emerges as the **central** explanation of both institutional and non-institutional political participation.
- **Issue engagement**, on the other hand, has very marginal effect at its best.

Variable	Model 4 (Inst.)	Model 9 (Non-inst.)
<i>Resources</i>		
Age	1.02 (0.00)***	1.00 (0.00)
Education	1.35 (0.10)**	1.26 (0.10)*
Income	1.06 (0.07)	1.05 (0.07)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>		
Political interest	1.50 (0.11)***	1.41 (0.10)***
Internal political efficacy	1.12 (0.08)	1.02 (0.08)
External political efficacy	1.01 (0.08)	0.89 (0.07)
Strength of partisan identification	1.50 (0.07)***	1.16 (0.06)*
<i>Issue engagement</i>		
Colonial political issues — historical	0.90 (0.12)	0.98 (0.11)
Colonial political issues — redistribution	0.93 (0.11)	0.95 (0.10)
<i>Mobilization</i>		
Frequency of political discussions	1.35 (0.10)**	1.38 (0.09)***
Social network size	0.94 (0.10)	0.91 (0.09)
Social network diversity	1.15 (0.09)	1.51 (0.09)***
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.092	0.058
N	811	810

Conclusion

- **IN CONTRAST**, a **resource-based** explanation for institutional participation **cannot be applied** to the same extent to **non-institutional** participation.
- **Mobilization** dynamics replace **resource constraints**.

Variable	Model 4 (Inst.)	Model 9 (Non-inst.)
<i>Resources</i>		
Age	1.02 (0.00)***	1.00 (0.00)
Education	1.35 (0.10)**	1.26 (0.10)*
Income	1.06 (0.07)	1.05 (0.07)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>		
Political interest	1.50 (0.11)***	1.41 (0.10)***
Internal political efficacy	1.12 (0.08)	1.02 (0.08)
External political efficacy	1.01 (0.08)	0.89 (0.07)
Strength of partisan identification	1.50 (0.07)***	1.16 (0.06)*
<i>Issue engagement</i>		
Colonial political issues — historical	0.90 (0.12)	0.98 (0.11)
Colonial political issues — redistribution	0.93 (0.11)	0.95 (0.10)
<i>Mobilization</i>		
Frequency of political discussions	1.35 (0.10)**	1.38 (0.09)***
Social network size	0.94 (0.10)	0.91 (0.09)
Social network diversity	1.15 (0.09)	1.51 (0.09)***
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.092	0.058
N	811	810

Dans un mémoire près de chez vous...

(Also studied in this master's thesis)

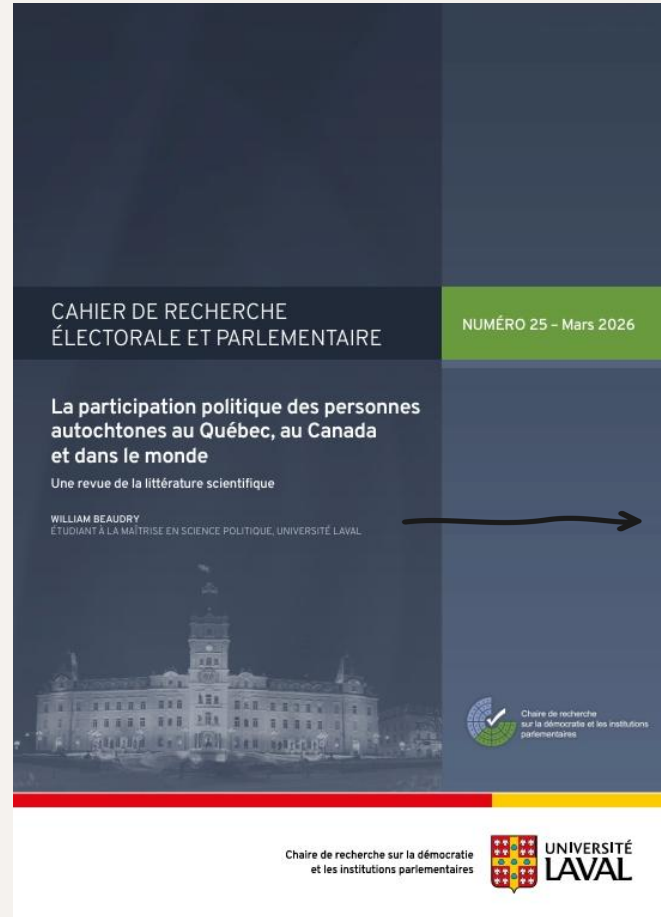
- My second question research goes as follow :

How do the explanations for the diverse forms of political participation compare between Indigenous and non-Indigenous peoples ?

- If you have questions about comparisons Indigenous/non-indigenous, feel free to ask !
- 

To get a good (in my honest opinion) overview of the literature

*Thanks to Juliettes Samson,
Ann-Sophie Gravel and, of course,
Pr. Valérie-Anne Mahéo for their
support into the making of this.*

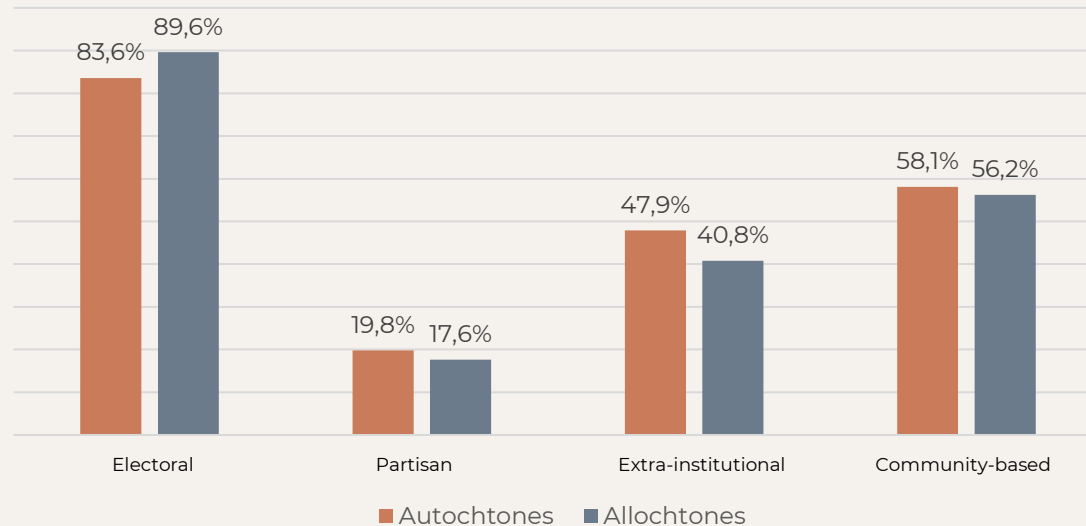


Some self-promoting

Thank you for
listening !

Appendix 1

Comparison of political participation levels between Indigenous and non-indigenous Canadians (*Democracy Checkups, 2020-2024*)



Appendix 2

Table A1: Nested recursive-block models explaining the institutional participation of Indigenous people (Models 0–5A; odds ratios with robust standard errors and significance)

Variable	Model 0	Model 1A	Model 2A	Model 3	Model 4	Model 5A
<i>Sociodemographic controls</i>						
2021 (ref. 2020)	0.97 (0.21)	0.93 (0.21)	0.99 (0.21)	1.20 (0.32)	1.25 (0.32)	0.99 (0.21)
2022 (ref. 2020)	1.24 (0.20)	1.17 (0.20)	1.13 (0.20)	1.22 (0.26)	1.22 (0.27)	1.13 (0.20)
2023 (ref. 2020)	0.90 (0.20)	0.85 (0.20)	0.88 (0.20)	0.87 (0.28)	0.93 (0.29)	0.92 (0.20)
2024 (ref. 2020)	1.08 (0.20)	1.04 (0.20)	1.07 (0.21)	1.15 (0.27)	1.17 (0.27)	1.06 (0.21)
Woman (ref. Man)	0.62 (0.12)***	0.71 (0.12)**	0.88 (0.12)	1.00 (0.15)	0.99 (0.15)	0.87 (0.12)
British Columbia (ref. Prairies)	1.25 (0.18)	1.16 (0.18)	1.10 (0.18)	1.17 (0.21)	1.13 (0.21)	1.06 (0.18)
Maritimes (ref. Prairies)	0.76 (0.21)	0.72 (0.21)	0.71 (0.21)	0.72 (0.26)	0.72 (0.26)	0.71 (0.21)
Ontario (ref. Prairies)	0.97 (0.15)	0.95 (0.15)	0.80 (0.15)	0.87 (0.18)	0.86 (0.18)	0.77 (0.15)†
Quebec (ref. Prairies)	0.99 (0.26)	1.03 (0.27)	0.88 (0.27)	0.97 (0.32)	1.01 (0.32)	0.89 (0.27)
Allophone (ref. Anglophone)	1.23 (0.34)	1.01 (0.34)	1.33 (0.34)	1.54 (0.41)	1.42 (0.41)	1.23 (0.35)
Francophone (ref. Anglophone)	1.64 (0.21)*	1.50 (0.22)†	1.61 (0.22)*	1.52 (0.27)	1.59 (0.27)†	1.65 (0.22)*
<i>Resources</i>						
Age		1.02 (0.00)***	1.02 (0.00)***	1.02 (0.00)***	1.02 (0.00)***	1.02 (0.00)***
Education		1.51 (0.09)***	1.41 (0.09)***	1.35 (0.10)**	1.35 (0.10)**	1.40 (0.09)***
Income		1.18 (0.06)**	1.11 (0.06)†	1.10 (0.07)	1.06 (0.07)	1.08 (0.06)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>						
Political interest			1.77 (0.09)***	1.72 (0.10)***	1.50 (0.11)***	1.55 (0.10)***
Internal political efficacy			1.11 (0.07)	1.15 (0.08)†	1.12 (0.08)	1.08 (0.07)
External political efficacy			1.02 (0.07)	1.02 (0.08)	1.01 (0.08)	1.01 (0.07)
Strength of partisan identification			1.58 (0.06)***	1.53 (0.07)***	1.50 (0.07)***	1.55 (0.06)***
<i>Issue engagement</i>						
Colonial political issues — historical				0.89 (0.12)	0.90 (0.12)	
Colonial political issues — redistribution				0.95 (0.11)	0.93 (0.11)	
<i>Mobilization</i>						
Frequency of political discussions					1.35 (0.10)**	1.31 (0.08)***
Social network size					0.94 (0.10)	1.03 (0.09)
Social network diversity					1.15 (0.09)	1.06 (0.07)
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.014	0.039	0.090	0.086	0.092	0.095
N	1,120	1,120	1,120	811	811	1,120

Appendix 3

Table A2: Nested recursive-block models explaining the non-institutional participation of Indigenous people (Models 0–10A; odds ratios with robust standard errors and significance)

Variable	Model 0	Model 6A	Model 7A	Model 8	Model 9	Model 10A
<i>Sociodemographic controls</i>						
2021 (ref. 2020)	0.96 (0.19)	0.95 (0.19)	1.02 (0.20)	1.06 (0.29)	1.10 (0.29)	1.06 (0.20)
2022 (ref. 2020)	0.89 (0.18)	0.88 (0.18)	0.87 (0.19)	0.86 (0.24)	0.82 (0.24)	0.84 (0.19)
2023 (ref. 2020)	0.55 (0.19)**	0.54 (0.19)***	0.55 (0.19)**	0.50 (0.27)**	0.58 (0.27)*	0.62 (0.19)*
2024 (ref. 2020)	0.70 (0.19)†	0.68 (0.19)*	0.69 (0.19)†	0.67 (0.24)†	0.69 (0.24)	0.70 (0.19)†
Woman (ref. Man)	1.38 (0.11)**	1.38 (0.11)**	1.79 (0.12)***	1.75 (0.14)***	1.78 (0.14)***	1.82 (0.12)***
British Columbia (ref. Prairies)	1.31 (0.16)†	1.28 (0.16)	1.27 (0.17)	1.35 (0.20)	1.24 (0.20)	1.16 (0.17)
Maritimes (ref. Prairies)	1.01 (0.19)	0.98 (0.19)	0.99 (0.20)	0.98 (0.24)	1.00 (0.24)	1.01 (0.20)
Ontario (ref. Prairies)	1.04 (0.14)	1.03 (0.14)	0.91 (0.14)	1.00 (0.17)	0.97 (0.17)	0.85 (0.14)
Quebec (ref. Prairies)	1.35 (0.25)	1.36 (0.25)	1.37 (0.25)	1.46 (0.30)	1.63 (0.30)	1.48 (0.25)
Allophone (ref. Anglophone)	0.97 (0.33)	0.91 (0.33)	1.16 (0.33)	1.18 (0.41)	0.96 (0.40)	0.92 (0.33)
Francophone (ref. Anglophone)	1.03 (0.20)	0.99 (0.20)	1.00 (0.20)	1.03 (0.25)	1.07 (0.26)	0.99 (0.20)
<i>Resources</i>						
Age		1.00 (0.00)	0.99 (0.00)*	0.99 (0.00)	1.00 (0.00)	0.99 (0.00)†
Education		1.35 (0.08)***	1.26 (0.08)**	1.30 (0.10)**	1.26 (0.10)*	1.24 (0.08)**
Income		1.09 (0.05)	1.02 (0.05)	1.08 (0.06)	1.05 (0.07)	0.99 (0.06)
<i>Psychological engagement</i>						
Political interest			1.73 (0.08)***	1.65 (0.09)***	1.41 (0.10)***	1.51 (0.09)***
Internal political efficacy			1.06 (0.06)	1.07 (0.08)	1.02 (0.08)	1.02 (0.06)
External political efficacy			0.92 (0.06)	0.92 (0.07)	0.89 (0.07)	0.89 (0.06)†
Strength of partisan identification			1.23 (0.05)***	1.18 (0.06)**	1.16 (0.06)*	1.20 (0.05)***
<i>Issue engagement</i>						
Colonial political issues — historical				0.97 (0.11)	0.98 (0.11)	
Colonial political issues — redistribution				1.01 (0.10)	0.95 (0.10)	
<i>Mobilization</i>						
Frequency of political discussions					1.38 (0.09)***	1.30 (0.07)***
Social network size					0.91 (0.09)	1.06 (0.08)
Social network diversity					1.51 (0.09)***	1.37 (0.07)***
McFadden pseudo- R^2	0.009	0.016	0.042	0.041	0.058	0.056
N	1,119	1,119	1,119	810	810	1,119

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